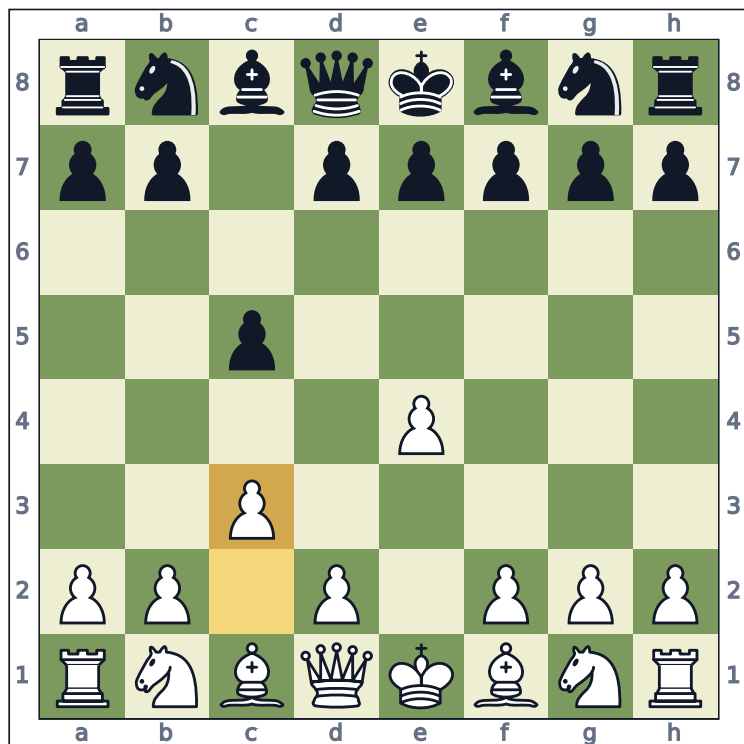


SICILIAN DEFENSE

Sicilian Defense

ECO B22 | 15 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.27 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Unbalanced and ambitious: both sides usually receive active plans and real winning chances.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

B22 covers Sicilian Defense. Black answers 1.e4 with ...c5, creating an asymmetrical center and immediate long-term counterplay. The diagram uses the featured line Sicilian Defense: Alapin Variation.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 c5 2. c3

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Develop rapidly, use d4 when appropriate, exploit central space, and decide whether play belongs on the kingside or in the center.

BLACK'S GOALS

Use the half-open c-file, pressure the center, prepare ...d5 or ...e5, and generate queenside or central counterplay.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

...d5 is often Black's equalizing break. White commonly uses e5, f4-f5, or a central sacrifice to open lines.

PIECE MAP

The c-file, d5 square, and development race are central. In opposite-side castling, every tempo matters. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Memorized attacks fail when the center or castling pattern differs by one move. Recalculate before launching pawns. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on c3, Black pawn on c5, White pawn on e4.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

A first-rate fighting defense with enormous depth. It is excellent, but specialized variations can be theory-heavy.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named B22 line

This section preserves all 15 names and defining routes assigned to B22 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Sicilian Defense: Alapin Variation

1. e4 c5 2. c3

002 Sicilian Defense: Alapin Variation, Anti-Alapin Gambit

1. e4 c5 2. c3 d5 3. exd5 Nf6

003 Sicilian Defense: Alapin Variation, Barmen Defense

1. e4 c5 2. c3 d5 3. exd5 Qxd5

004 Sicilian Defense: Alapin Variation, Barmen Defense

1. e4 c5 2. c3 d5 3. exd5 Qxd5 4. d4 Nc6 5. Nf3

005 Sicilian Defense: Alapin Variation, Barmen Defense

1. e4 c5 2. c3 d5 3. exd5 Qxd5 4. d4 g6 5. Nf3

006 Sicilian Defense: Alapin Variation, Barmen Defense, Central Exchange

1. e4 c5 2. c3 d5 3. exd5 Qxd5 4. d4 cxd4 5. cxd4 Nc6 6. Nf3 Bg4

007 Sicilian Defense: Alapin Variation, Barmen Defense, Endgame Variation

1. e4 c5 2. c3 d5 3. exd5 Qxd5 4. d4 cxd4 5. cxd4 Nc6 6. Nf3 Bg4 7. Nc3 Bxf3 8. gxf3 Qxd4 9. Qxd4 Nxd4

008 Sicilian Defense: Alapin Variation, Barmen Defense, Milner-Barry Attack

1. e4 c5 2. c3 d5 3. exd5 Qxd5 4. d4 Nc6 5. Nf3 cxd4 6. cxd4 e5 7. Nc3 Bb4 8. Be2

009 Sicilian Defense: Alapin Variation, Barmen Defense, Modern Line

1. e4 c5 2. c3 d5 3. exd5 Qxd5 4. d4 Nf6 5. Nf3 Bg4

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named B22 line

This section preserves all 15 names and defining routes assigned to B22 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

010 Sicilian Defense: Alapin Variation, Smith-Morra Declined

1. e4 c5 2. c3 Nf6 3. e5 Nd5 4. d4 cxd4

011 Sicilian Defense: Alapin Variation, Stoltz Attack

1. e4 c5 2. c3 Nf6 3. e5 Nd5 4. Nf3 Nc6 5. Bc4 Nb6 6. Bb3

012 Sicilian Defense: Alapin Variation, Stoltz Attack, Ivanchuk Line

1. e4 c5 2. c3 Nf6 3. e5 Nd5 4. Nf3 Nc6 5. Bc4 Nb6 6. Bb3 c4 7. Bc2 Qc7 8. Qe2 g5

013 Sicilian Defense: Delayed Alapin Variation

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. c3 d5 4. exd5 Qxd5 5. d4 Nf6

014 Sicilian Defense: Delayed Alapin Variation

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. c3 d5 4. exd5 exd5 5. Bb5+ Nc6 6. O-O Bd6 7. d4

015 Sicilian Defense: Heidenfeld Variation

1. e4 c5 2. c3 Nf6 3. e5 Nd5 4. Nf3 Nc6 5. Na3